

► PRE-CUT AND RECYCLED FABRIC

Pre-cut fabrics are a package of coordinating fabrics from a manufacturer that have all been cut to the same size. This makes them very handy for patchwork projects in which you'd like a large variety of fabrics, but without buying fabric from the bolt. The popularity of pre-cut fabrics has grown dramatically in the last few years. Manufacturers have increased their ranges available in pre-cuts as well as the available shapes they

produce. Many manufacturers have patterns made specifically from pre-cuts. Nowadays you can easily find Charm Squares™, Layer Cakes™, Jelly Rolls™, and even pre-cut triangles and hexagons in local shops and online. Using these pre-cuts is a quick and easy way to layout and sew together a quilt in hours, rather than days.

Fat quarters

Fat quarters are the most common type of pre-cut referring to a quarter-yard cut of fabric. A normal quarter-yard cut off the bolt would give you 23 x 112cm (9 x 44in), but a fat quarter is a 46cm (18in) cut from the bolt, which is folded selvedge to selvedge and trimmed in half down the middle to give you a 46 x 56cm (18 x 22in) piece of fabric, although sizes can vary slightly from manufacturer to manufacturer. Fat quarters are sometimes more useful than a 23cm (9in) cut from the bolt, as they allow for a larger pattern repeat.

Fat eighths

Fat eighths are half of a fat quarter ($\frac{1}{8}$ yard), measuring approximately 23 x 56cm (9 x 22in), rather than a typical $\frac{1}{8}$ yard cut off the bolt, which would give you 12 x 112cm ($4\frac{1}{2}$ x 44in) of fabric.



Recycled fabric

The very first quilts were often made from whatever worn-out fabrics were available, giving them a second life and saving money. Recycled fabric can be salvaged from almost anything. A slightly stained shirt, old table linen, or denim from jeans can be used to create a personal project. Very often the fabric is well-broken-in giving it a soft feel and heirloom appearance. It also usually will not shrink any further or leach dye as it has most likely been laundered on many previous occasions. Take care when adding recycled fabrics to any project, as the weight of the fabrics may be different from that of the other fabrics you are using.

